3

Make a Robot

Give the robot apocalypse a push in the back by building your own. The Society of Robots (not, as the name suggests, a precursor to Skynet) gives you a bunch of tutorials on basic robotics – from how to create a simple robot to all the information you need on components to build a bigger, better bot. It's even got helpful tools to help you figure out what batteries you need and how much energy your bot is going to consume. Finding the components, though, will be an adventure on its own.

For: Budding engineers, foolish optimists

Read: www.societyofrobots.com

image credit: Mr. T in DC (flickr)

4

Talk Business

If you're planning on starting your own company eventually (and who isn't), head over to the US Small Business Administration's web site for its free "Small Business Primer". Learn how you can start your own business (on a shoestring budget, even), manage technology, create a business plan, and a lot more. Even if you aren't planning on running a business, the site is loaded with plenty of management advice that applies everywhere – managing people, time and resources, for example. If nothing else, it's great ammunition for an IIM admission interview.

For: Working professionals

Read: http://www.sba.gov/services/training/onlinecourses/TRANING_ATC_BUS.html

credit: by Ajda Gregorčič (flickr)

5

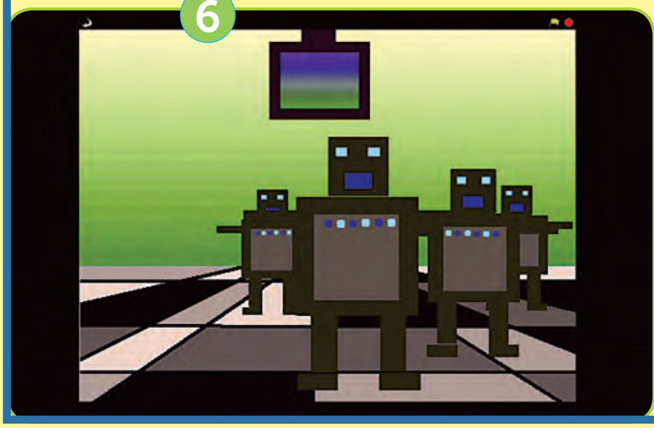
Become An Edu-tuber

Bookmark YouTubeEDU for your daily dose of academic lectures from universities such as Harvard, MIT and Stanford. The channel hosts almost every expert lecture being held at these universities, and you'll even find a course or two tucked away somewhere. Whether you want to follow up on the latest developments in brain-computer interfaces or the science behind Angels and Demons (spoiler: antimatter is harmless), YouTubeEDU's got the goods.

For: Everyone

Watch: www.youtube.com/edu

credit: doviende (flickr)



6

Scratch Up A Movie

Computational thinking is all the rage these days. Business and design professors recommend it for students in their fields, and the world is slowly realising that it pays to think like a programmer – to apply the basics of computer science to solve problems, plan systems, and even deal with other humans. And with Scratch, MIT's Lifelong Kindergarten group wants you (and your children) to learn those basics by applying them to the fine art of silly-looking animation. Use if.. conditions, for loops, and other such constructs to tell a story, and you'll be a much happier panda.

For: Ages 8 and up

Get it: scratch.mit.edu